

Diamond Heist

Introduction

The Modern Artworks Museum is a marbled jewel-box of an institution. Artistic and material treasures lie inside its well-enchanted display cases. And a displaced djinni wants one of those treasures very badly indeed. Bring her that treasure in the next three days, and she offers a single *wish* as reward – the power to bring about anything you desire.

In the course of this adventure, players must case out the defenses of the Modern Artworks Museum, disable the protective wards, and finally battle with the enchanted statue that holds the treasure. The module is designed to be played by a party of 6th - 9th level characters and last 4-7 hours.

Running the Adventure

Players have three days to accomplish three steps of the heist – discover the museum's defenses, disable the defenses, and steal the gem and escape.

To keep one bad roll from ruining the adventure, Diamond Heist modifies the usual pass/fail skill check system. Instead of failure, a bad skill check causes the alarm level of the museum to rise and makes further skill checks slightly more difficult. See the section on Alarm Levels for more details.

The last page of this module is a brochure handout. Have a copy of this printout ready to give to your players when they enter the museum.

The Modern Artworks Museum should be placed in a wealthy, cosmopolitan city where high-level enchantments are accessible. The works and names described in the module are based on Renaissance Italy.

Adventure Hook

Glory Strikes the Storm, a displaced noble djinni from the Elemental Plane of Air, wants her diamond back. After years, she has tracked it to a public art gallery only to find the museum warded against elemental beings. In the few days remaining before the museum rotates exhibits, she is searching for someone to steal the diamond for her. She is willing to grant one *wish* in return for the diamond.

Glory Strikes the Storm prowls the city disguised as a well-dressed, burly humanoid. The party may catch her interest by possessing magical items (discerned via *detect magic*), general battle-worthy appearance, or rumors of their past accomplishments. She is not impressed with the city mercenaries and refuses to work with the thieves' guild. She is getting desperate and will gamble on the first competent-seeming, magically inclined group she can find.

Within the city, the players might encounter the disguised djinni at:

- A fine inn or gambling hall, listening in on conversation
- Arguing with clerics at a temple to a chaotic good or air-aligned deity
- At their lodgings, after she follows a rumor to their location

A Friend of the Family

When Glory Strikes the Storm approaches, read:

A tall woman strides towards you. She is powerfully built and dressed in nearly impractical finery. Her features are strong and carelessly ugly. Her grey hair shifts restlessly around her head, and she moves with athletic, impatient gestures.

In her humanoid form, Glory Strikes the Storm asks the party for a private word. She explains that she wants a certain diamond from the Modern Artworks Museum. If the party can get her the diamond before the exhibits rotate in three days, she will grant one of them a single wish.

If the party doubts her ability to fulfill this spectacular promise, she takes offense and transforms into her true shape.

With a roll of thunder, clouds consume the woman's form. She doubles, triples in size, becoming a pillar of purple thunderclouds. The pillar fills the room, crackling with lightning. Glittering stars and cloud form an inhuman face, and a pair of burly purple arms spring from the swirling tempest. "I am a noble djinni, and I offer you my favor or my displeasure," she booms.

If the party is suitably deferent after this display, Glory Strikes the Storm reverts to her humanoid shape.

The djinni is desperate enough to work with even a rude party, but the characters' behavior in this segment determines how she behaves if she gains access to the gallery.

If the party accepts her offer, the djinni leads them immediately to the art gallery and explains everything that she knows about the situation.

- She wants the diamond returned to her or destroyed
- The museum rotates exhibits in three days. She does not know where the diamond will go next and does not want to track it down again.
- She is certain her diamond is somewhere inside but does not know where. The diamond is small and glitters with an internal light.
- There is a magic circle placed over the entire building
- She suspects that you cannot teleport in or out of the museum.

Casing the Joint

For the first phase of the heist, characters must explore the gallery to discover what defenses they need

to overcome. The section below outlines all of the museum's security measures. The appearance of these features is described in the room in which they first appear in "The Modern Artworks Museum" section.

Forcecages

Display cases house all of the gallery's artifacts, but their real protections are permanent *forcecages* behind the glass of all of the exhibits (see Appendix B). This enchantment is sustained by three runes spread around the museum. If all three runes are disabled, the *forcecages* disappear. The runes are located in areas 2, 7b, and 11.

A player who examines a *forcecage* and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) skill check recognizes it for what it is.

Disabling the *forcecage* runes are the key to a successful heist. Steer players towards information about the runes soon as possible. The Arcane Calligraphy exhibit, Library, Dr. Halftusk, Rinaldo Bardi, Luca Lomeo, and Glory Strikes the Storm can all give information of varying quality.

The *forcecages* themselves are visually described in area 2. The runes are described in area 11. Each *forcecage* rune looks like a circle split into three parts, representing the three total runes that power the *forcecages*.

Magic Circle

A *magic circle* covers the entire museum, preventing extraplanar creatures from entering (see Appendix B). This includes creatures created with the *find familiar* spell.

The *magic circle* is maintained by a single rune in area 12. If it is disabled, the magic circle disappears.

Foo Dogs

Enchanted guardians of the gallery, foo dog statues dispel invisibility and patrol the galleries at night (see Appendix A).

The foo dogs all have five magical gems on their forehead. One lights up each time the alarm level increases.

At night, the foo dogs leave their plinths and patrol the museum. While patrolling, a foo dog attacks anyone who is not a museum employee.

During the day, foo dogs are stationed in areas 3, 4, 7a, 5 (second floor), 10, and 16.

Guards

Guards – fighters and wizards – are stationed throughout the museum. As the alarm level of the museum goes up, all guards get bonuses to Wisdom (Perception and Insight) checks. See the section on Alarm Level for more detail and Appendix A for stats.

Private Sanctum

A private sanctum spell covers the museum (see Appendix B). It forbids divination sensors, interplanar travel, and teleportation in or out of the museum.

The private sanctum spell is not attached to any rune and cannot be suppressed or removed.

Runes

The forcecage and magic circle enchantments are powered by runes, magical sigils carved into wood or stone. Players must disable the runes by physically damaging them or suppressing their magic. If all of the runes that maintain an enchantment are disabled, the enchantment stops functioning.

Disabling All runes have an AC of 14 and resistance to bludgeoning, piercing and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons. Each rune has 10 hit points before it becomes disabled.

Dispelling magic cast on a rune suppresses its effect for one hour. In this module, all areas that contain a rune are marked with an (R) after the name.

Alarm Level

In the course of the adventure, players must evade the attention of guards, who do not smile upon guests in staff areas, casting spells, attacking, or picking locks. If a player tries to evade a guard's notice for any reason, the player rolls a Dexterity (Stealth) check against the guard's Wisdom (Perception) check. A character who succeeds goes unnoticed.

Alternately, a character may try to talk their way into or out of a situation. In this case, the character rolls a Charisma (Deception or Performance) check against the guard's Wisdom (Insight). A character who succeeds fools their target.

In both cases, a character who fails is not caught. Allow them to continue their course of action. The penalty of a failed check is not failure to complete the action. Instead, a failed check raises the alarm level of the museum. This allows even clumsy characters to participate in the heist.

Interpreting Failure. Narrate events that raise the alarm level as close shaves. A failed Stealth check means that a guard pauses, comes within inches of a player's hiding spot, then moves on.

Raising the Alarm

The alarm level starts at 0 each day and goes up to 5. When the alarm level increases, a guard will tap the nearest foo dog on the head, illuminating an additional gem. At each alarm level, all museum guards gain a cumulative +1 bonus to Wisdom (Perception and Insight) checks.

At alarm level 5, the museum closes immediately (day) or the city guard is summoned (night). The guards and foo dogs do a full sweep of the museum. The next day, the museum opens at alarm level 1.

Most failed checks raise the alarm by one. As GM, you might decide that especially flagrant actions raise the alarm level more than one at a time.

Day and Night

During normal hours, the museum opens at 10am and closes at 6pm. After the museum closes, the guards lock the front doors, activate the foo dogs, and do a sweep of all three floors. During this sweep, all of the wizard guards cast detect magic. The lights stay on at night.

At night, the museum security has the following differences. The foo dogs patrol their floors, attacking any non-guard that they encounter. There are fewer guards on each floor, and all non-guard NPCs and guests are absent.

The Modern Artworks Museum

The map/layout of the museum is described in each room.

Exterior:

A three-story marble edifice stands before you, frosted with sculptures and scrollwork. Columns flank the broad frontage like bars of an enormous cage.

The museum is divided into public and staff areas. Unless noted, there are no windows in any of the rooms. Glory's diamond is held by a statue in the Merfolk Sculpture exhibit (area 18).

If detect magic or similar is cast on the museum, players see the private sanctum and magic circle enchantments covering the entire structure. Casting dispel magic has no effect.

If the players get stuck finding the security system clues, Glory Strikes the Storm is a useful resource. Have her greet the players when they exit the museum - she is knowledgeable about all kinds of magic.

Occupants: In addition to the guards, museum docents are available in each exhibit to answer questions. Archivists and curators move around in the staff sections of the library.

Interior: Unless otherwise noted, the walls and ceilings are of white stone. The floor is covered with lacquered terracotta tiles. Magical globules of white light illuminate each room from the edges of the ceiling.

First Floor

Characters enter through the north door in the Foyer (area 1). Places of note include the Arcane Calligraphy gallery (4), the Library (6), and the Archive (7b). Dr. Halftusk and Luca Lomeo can be found on this floor.

1. Foyer

Decorative pillars extend the length of this imposing entryway. A semicircular arch frames the doorway at the end of the hall, and embellished panels decorate the ceiling. There is a single marble statue in the center of the room, a fox jumping from the back of a rearing lion. The fox clutches a bunch of grapes in its mouth, just out of reach of the lion's wheel-sized paw.

An attendant sells tickets to the museum at a desk on the western wall of the foyer. Tickets cost 4gp a person for a day pass. The attendant hands a brochure to each guest with their ticket. Give your players a copy of the brochure handout included with this module.

The brochure contains a map of the galleries and a schedule of upcoming events. These are:

- An afternoon seminar on the first day taught by the head curator of the museum. Meets at 4pm in the Arcane Calligraphy gallery
- A sketch-and-sip event in the evening of the second day, held in the museum cafe under the frescoes
- A fundraising gala held after hours on the third day. A ticketed black-tie event

The attendant informs all guests that no weapons, magic, food or drink are allowed in the galleries.

If asked about exhibits with diamonds, the attendant (or any other employee) responds that there is no dedicated gem exhibit, but gems are incorporated into works in many of the galleries.

One museum guard and one wizard guard stand at the entrance to the exhibits. The wizard guard has a gem of seeing that they use on anyone who appears suspicious. Any characters with visible weapons are asked to leave them at the front desk.

At night, the front door is secured with a lock and a deadbolt. Using thieves' tools, a character can pick the lock with a successful DC 25 Dexterity check.

Layout

Northeast corner of building. Square, 35 feet by 35 feet. Open doorway on south wall to Area 2

2. Frescoes

Swathes of color break up the white, filigreed expanse of this room. Behind glass, plaster panels show muscular figures in blues, browns, and gold. Their gauzy clothes leave little anatomy to the imagination, and they are frozen in poses of combat, supplication, and romance.

One wizard guard stands in this room. This guard station is occupied at night.

If a character examines the exhibits more closely:

Just behind the glass, the air shimmers faintly, like oil on water.

This is the forcecage enchantment. It is visible behind the glass in all of the galleries.

Layout

Southeast corner of building. Square, 35 feet by 35 feet. Open doorway on north wall to Area 2. Open doorway in west wall to Area 3.

3. Arms of Saint Sergia

Display cases house old-fashioned armor and weapons on wooden mannequins. The cases show a mixture of replicas and pitted metal artifacts. At the north end of the hall, a shimmering illusion of an armored woman holds a glowing hammer and smiles at passing guests. A large stone statue of a dog-like creature sits next to her; and next to the dog a discrete door.

If players approach the statue:

A large statue of a dragon-like lion stands on a plinth; its bulging eyes, swirling mane, and grinning open mouth are comical but unnerving. Five clear gems gleam in its forehead.

This is a foo dog. Detect magic or similar on the statue gives a strong aura of conjuration and abjuration magic.

If the museum alarm level is more than zero, the corresponding number of gems on the statue's head are lit.

A locked door in the north wall leads to the staff area of the museum. It can be unlocked with a successful DC 16 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

Layout

South side of building. 30 feet by 35 feet. Locked door in north wall that leads to Area 6. West side of the room turns into Area 5.

4. Arcane Calligraphy

Shadowboxes line the double hallway of this gallery. Each box contains parchment painted with elegant arcane runes. A large table takes up the center of the room. There is a set of unmarked double doors on the north wall and a dog statue next to them.

If players examine the table:

The table in the center of the room holds an open tome underneath protective glass. A circular sigil takes up the pages, all concentric rings and arcane symbols. The sigil is slashed through with ink, breaking the complex lines of the glyph. A plaque on the display reads "Conjuration rune, deactivated."

The exhibits in this room are similar to the runes that protect the museum. Plaques around the room inform readers that these are genuine, deactivated magical scrolls. Close observers notice that all of the scrolls have small tears through the central sigil, though none so dramatic as the tome on the table.

A player who studies the scrolls and tabletop tome can make a DC 12 Intelligence (Arcana) check. On a success, the player knows that runes sustain magical enchantments and that damaging the rune breaks the enchantment.

A wizard who studies the scrolls for one hour and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check can decipher one first-level spell of your choice to be copied into their spell book.

There is a foo dog statue in the northeast corner of the exhibit. Locked double doors in the north wall lead to the archive staging area. They can be unlocked using thieves' tools with a successful DC 16 Dexterity check.

Dr. Carda Halftusk meets seminar attendees here on the first day. She then leads them up to the southwest meeting room on the second floor.

A middle-aged woman with a dash of orc blood greets you – she is heavily built, and small tusks protrude from her lower jaw. She wears an elegant dress with complicated puffed sleeves, and a pair of spectacles perch on her nose.

More information about Dr. Halftusk is provided in area 15 and Appendix A.

Layout

South side of the building. 30 feet by 35 feet. Locked double doors in north wall lead to Area 7a. East side turns into Area 5.

5. Staircases

A broad staircase with elaborate carved bannisters leads to the other museum floors. A chalkboard sign points the way to guest restrooms.

On the first floor, a museum guard stands watch near the base of the stairs. This station is occupied at night. On the second floor, a foo dog sits between the two staircases. Restrooms are on the north side of the staircases on the first and second floors.

Event: Fundraiser On the third night, the museum hosts a black-tie gala. Tickets cost 10gp apiece. The fundraiser goes from 6pm until midnight, and guests can enjoy the exhibits and complimentary food and drink. Dr. Halftusk and Rinaldo Bardi attend. Any characters who arrive in especially fine clothes have advantage on all Charisma checks for the evening.

Layout

Floor 1: Staircase going up is 10 feet by 15 feet. Door behind the staircase leads to restrooms. East side turns into Area 3, west side turns into Area 4.

Floor 2: East staircase goes down to Floor 1, west staircase goes up to Floor 3. Door behind the staircase leads to restrooms. East side turns into Area 9, west side turns into Area 8.

6. Library

Businesslike bookshelves fill this wide, low-ceilinged room. Some of them contain files, other hold rows of plainly bound books.

The museum stores reference material here. The subject matter is dry and technical. If characters spend ten minutes searching the shelves, they may roll an Intelligence (Investigation) check to see what information they discover about the museum.

- 0 - 10: Nothing.
- 11 - 16: Book describing the three primary enchantments that protect the museum, forcecage,

private sanctum, and magic circle. Allow players to read the full text for each spell.

- 17+: The book above as well as a second record that details the location of each spell rune.

There is a 50% chance that Luca Lomeo is here (see Scriptorium, area 12).

Layout

North side of the building. Hallway has three doors, one leads to stairwell, one leads to Library, one leads to Area 7a. Stairwell leads to Area 12. Library is 40 feet by 20 feet.

7a. Archive Stage

A broad, quiet room. There are heavy metal doors on the western wall and a dragon-dog statue in the northwest corner.

The archive stage is used to unpack archived items for display and occasional cleaning. There is a foo dog in the northwest corner.

The double doors on the western wall are sealed with an arcane lock spell. This raises the difficulty to pick the lock with thieves' tools from DC 18 to DC 28. The door has AC 20 and 50HP. Dr. Halftusk keeps the key to this door in her office.

The interior set of double doors is not locked.

Layout

North side of the building. L-shaped room 30 feet by 35 feet. Locked double doors in west wall lead to Area 7b. Locked double doors in south wall lead to Area 4. Door in east wall leads to hallway to Area 6.

7b. Archives (R)

Complete darkness greets you. The air smells stale and sweet.

The archives are enchanted with a permanent darkness spell, impenetrable even to creatures with darkvision. Any source of light lasts for 1 round before being snuffed out. Light sources can be re-lit or re-cast, lasting for one round each time. The password *lux et veritas* lifts the darkness enchantment for ten minutes. Dr. Halftusk and Luca Lomeo know this password.

In the brief light, you see walls made of sliding steel drawers of sizes to hold everything from matchboxes to wagons. The stacks of drawers on the edges of the room are only five feet lower than the ceiling.

Ten-foot high steel drawers line the walls of the room, leaving a five-foot gap to the ceiling above them. There is a forceage rune carved into the southeastern wall above the ledge of drawers.

On the western and southern sides of the room, walls of drawers go all the way up to the ceiling and extend into the center of the room. The exterior walls of the room are five feet thick and enchanted to repel passwall and other means of magical bypass.

The locks on all of the drawers are enchanted with individual alarm spells. They make a loud ringing sound when opened, whether picked (DC 25 Dexterity check with thieves' tools) or unlocked with a key.

Layout

West side of the building. 30 feet by 60 feet. Double doors in east wall lead to Area 7a.

Second Floor

The second story of the museum. Areas of note include the Mithril of Ornhelm gallery (area 11) and the Scriptorium (area 12). Rinaldo Bardi and Luca Lomeo can be found on this floor.

8. Divine Triptychs

This L-shaped exhibit displays many painted triptychs. Each triptych is made of three elaborately framed panels hinged together; some the size of windows and others small enough to hang on a locket chain. The scenes in each triptych depict the myths and avatars of various gods. One guard stands watch on the west wall.

There is a museum guard by the western wall of the room. Plaques below each exhibit describe the deities depicted.

When the players enter this room for the first time, Rinaldo Bardi (NE male human noble) is harassing the guard (see Appendix A). He laments what a dead-end job the guard has and that he, Rinaldo, should have quit even sooner. He only gave it a chance as a favor to his uncle, the museum director. Shortly after the players appear, another guard barely controlling their temper escorts Rinaldo out of the museum.

Rinaldo Bardi

A young man dressed in an overfine cloak and curled shoes, he keeps one eyebrow quirked in a fixed expression of ironic incredulity.

If the players ask Rinaldo about the museum security, he will happily tell them everything he knows.

Learning that they want to steal something only increases his eagerness to help. He did not work at the museum for long and was terrible at his job, so his information is not detailed.

- Forcecages: There is some kind of force field behind the exhibit glass
- Runes: The runes on the walls have something to do with the force fields. There are a few in staff areas.
- Museum layout: Mostly offices, and a vault on the first floor where they keep stuff not on display.

Rinaldo still has his staff key, and he will sell it to players for 300gp. It opens the doors in areas 3, 4, and 10.

Layout

South side of building. L-shaped room 30 feet by 60 feet. Wide hallway leads to Area 5.

9. Tapestry Art

Carpet-sized tapestries hang from gold rods behind panes of glass. The bright fabrics depict banquets, hunting parties and landscapes in isometric perspective.

A simple gallery.

Layout

South side of building. 45 feet by 40 feet. West side turns into Area 5, east side turns into Area 11, north side turns into Area 10.

10. Statuary

Snowy marble statues flank the walls of this gallery. The figures are startlingly lifelike, adorned with fluid stone robes and placid, perfectly symmetrical faces. There is a discrete door in the western wall and a dog statue in the northwest corner.

There is a foo dog positioned in the northeastern corner of this gallery (description in area 3). The western door is locked. A player who makes a successful DC 16 Dexterity check with thieves' tools can unlock the door.

Layout

20 feet by 35 feet. South side turns into Area 9, east side turns into Area 11. Locked door in west wall leads to staff hallway.

11. Mithril of Ornhelm (R)

Under heavier guard than the rest of the exhibits, pale metal items gleam from inside glass cases. Dwarf-sized jewelry, goblets, mirrors, armor and toys shine with silvery-blue metal.

The artworks held in this exhibit are the most valuable in the museum. There are museum guards posted in the northeastern and south sides of the gallery, and a wizard guard on the eastern wall. The two southeastern guard positions are occupied at night.

Forcecage rune

There is a forcecage rune carved 12 feet up the eastern wall of the exhibit.

A circular glyph, two feet in diameter, is carved into the stone. The circle is split into three sections. Traces of red sparkle in the grooves of the carving.

Players who succeed on a DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) check notice similarities with the exhibits in the Arcane Calligraphy gallery. Players who succeed by 4 or more realize that this is one of three glyphs in a set.

Layout

East side of the building. 20 feet by 70 feet. Northwest side turns into Area 10, southwest side turns into Area 9.

12. Scriptorium (R)

This cluttered room is filled with papers, files and inkwells. A magnificent wood table covered with a thick sheet of clear quartz dominates the room. A young elvish man with ink smeared on his cheek is busy at the bookshelf.

This room is the domain of Luca Lomeo (NG male elf acolyte), the museum's scribe.

Luca Lomeo

Overworked, overqualified and underpaid, Luca has too much on his mind to be suspicious. He rolls all Wisdom (Insight) checks with disadvantage. He assumes that anyone who gets into the staff areas has a reason to be there and distractedly answers any questions asked of him.

Luca knows how all of the runes function, where they are, and the password to deactivate the darkness spell in the archives: lux et veritas. If he becomes suspicious of the characters, he makes an excuse to leave and raises the alarm level of the museum by one.

Magic Circle Rune

If players enter the Scriptorium:

Underneath the quartz tabletop, there is a large five-pointed star carved into the wood. Each point bears a different symbol – sun, moon, diamond, inverted triangle, and skull. Complex lines cross over all of the symbols and the points of the star.

The museum's magic circle rune is carved into the wooden surface of the central table. The tabletop is completely covered with a thick sheet of quartz. The sheet requires a collective Strength score of 25 to lift.

If the magic circle rune is deactivated, Glory Strikes the Storm enters the museum. She is a powerful ally, but she is not subtle and may not heed the party's instructions.

Layout

North side of the building. Staff hallway leads from Area 10. 25 feet by 15 feet.

13. Offices

A practical office outfitted with the usual furnishings – desk, bookshelves, and overflowing waste basket.

These offices contain little besides personal affects, though some of the books have resale value.

Layout

Staff hallway leads to four offices on the north and west sides of the building. 10 feet by 15 feet.

14. Dr. Halftusk's Office

A placard on the outside of the door reads “Dr. Carda Halftusk, Senior Curator.” Inside, the large office is graced with windows overlooking the street outside. An L-shaped desk takes up the north end of the room, a double bookshelf the south.

There is a 50% chance that Dr. Halftusk is in her office.

Dr. Halftusk keeps keys to the Archive (area 7b) locked in the top drawer of her desk. This drawer can be unlocked with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. Players who inspect the bookshelf may make the same Intelligence (Investigation) check offered in the Library (area 6) to gain the same possible information.

Layout

Northwest corner of the building, 20 feet by 25 feet. Door in eastern wall leads to staff hallway.

15. Meeting Room

Large tables and ambient boredom - a conference room.

Dr. Carda Halftusk (LN female half-orc noble) leads players who attend the seminar through the staff area to the southwestern meeting room, where the class takes place.

Event: Seminar. In the afternoon on the first day, Dr. Halftusk gives a free lecture on the history of jewelry design. She shows off several pieces from the Archives as part of her lecture. She is happy to talk with students after the seminar.

Dr. Carda Halftusk

Dr. Halftusk (LN female half-orc noble) is familiar with every artifact in the museum, and if Glory's diamond is described to her, she directs the party to the Water Sculpture exhibit.

Security is a different matter. Dr. Halftusk is no fool, and she will not willingly divulge any information about the museum's defenses. However, a questioner who spins the conversation as scholarly inquiry about wards in general (as might be gleaned from the Arcane Calligraphy exhibit) can get quite a bit of information out of her.

If her suspicions are not aroused, she can reveal...

- Runes sustain long-lasting enchantments
- The lines of a rune must be intact to function, and they are usually carved into hard materials to protect them from damage
- Important enchantments are often split into multiple runes. The enchantment continues to function unless all of the child runes are disrupted

If questions become too pointed towards the museum's protections, Dr. Halftusk ends the conversation and the alarm level of the museum goes up by one.

Layout

Two rooms on the north and southwestern sides of the building. 30 feet by 20 feet. Door on the north wall leads to staff hallway.

Third Floor

The third floor of the museum. Areas of note include the Cafe and Merfolk Sculpture gallery, where Glory's diamond is held. Florence the Cat can be encountered here.

16. Cafe and Shop (R)

Beautiful frescoes cover the ceiling of this room. On the south side of the room, shelves display books about art history and miniature replicas of the museum's famous statues. On the north side of the room, guests can enjoy cafe fare at clustered tables and chairs. A chalkboard sign next to the cashier on the north wall displays upcoming events.

The ceiling of this room is 20 feet high. There is a gap in the painted plaster above the northern side of the room, and there is a forceage rune carved into the ceiling there (description in area 11). Characters with a Passive Perception of 15 or higher notice the rune. Any character who takes a moment to observe the ceiling sees the rune as well.

There are no guards in this part of the museum, but the cafe is always busy. Accomplishing a task covertly requires a DC 18 Dexterity (Stealth) check to avoid catching the attention of one of the many lunching guests.

Event: Sketch and Sip. In the evening on the second day, the museum hosts a Sketch and Sip figure drawing class. The cafe closes to regular diners, and for a fee of 3gp patrons get charcoal and paper, a live model to draw, and bottomless wine. Between focus on their artwork and freely available drink, guests become much less attentive. For the duration of the class, doing something unnoticed in the cafe requires only a DC 10 Dexterity (Stealth) check.

Florence the Cat

Florence (CE female halfling assassin) attends the Sketch and Sip class to find drunk, wealthy marks for pickpocketing. Players at the event notice her watching the artists much more than the model.

You see a halfling woman dressed in a simple, dark suit. She has a scar on her chin, a tattoo on her right wrist, and wears a gold ring on the middle finger of each hand.

Her practiced eye notices any characters making Dexterity (Stealth) checks. She approaches these characters after the class and makes small talk. Any characters who understand Thieves' Cant realize that she is really asking if they are trying to break into the museum.

If the players respond in kind, Florence suggests that they work together. She has her eye on some valuable artwork, and if they disable the museum's security together, everyone can take what they want (see Appendix A).

Layout

West side of the building. 30 feet by 45 feet. Open doorway in east wall leads to Area 17.

17. Dominic Halftusk Memorial Gallery

Dozens of tiny shelves cover the walls of this gallery, each set with an arrangement of tea ware.

Teapots and teacups in patterned porcelain dominate the northern and eastern walls, while the southern wall shows a display of painted violins. One guard stands watch on the southern wall.

A wizard guard is stationed at the head of the staircase. Their main job is to remind guests that they cannot bring food out of the cafe area. This station is occupied at night.

Layout

45 feet by 45 feet, center of the building. Staircase in the center of the room. Open western doorway leads to Area 16, open eastern doorway leads to Area 18.

18. Merfolk Sculpture (Gem)

Cylindrical tanks of water fill this room. Each tank contains a sculpture made of glass, wood and fabric floating in the center of the chamber. The sculptures shift through refracted glass and water as you walk around them. There is a guard on watch in the southeast corner, and an elderly artist working in the northeast corner, and a dog statue in the northwest corner.

The water inside the sculpture tanks makes the forcecages more noticeable in this exhibit.

An elderly halfling of indeterminate gender sits on a bench in the northeastern corner. They are painting a watercolor of one of the statues on a small pad. If asked about their work, the painter complains that, "These damn forcecages make the water hard to paint."

There is a foo dog in the northwest corner and one museum guard in the southeast corner.

If players come within 10 feet of Anadyomene's tank:

A tank in the center of the room holds a life-size feminine sculpture of wood and stone. She floats with her weight shifted onto one hip, legs held modestly together, one hand over her groin and the other over her breast. Her head is tipped to one side, a serene smile on her face. Long hair drifts freely around her in the water. The hand over her heart holds a clear gem that glitters with internal light. The statue is titled Anadyomene (An-na-DIE-oh-men-ee).

This is the gem that Glory Strikes the Storm wants. A player who examines the statue and succeeds on a DC 20 Intelligence (Arcana) check suspects that the whole statue, not just the gem, is magical.

Layout

45 feet by 45 feet, east side of building. Open western doorway leads to Area 17.

A Piece of Work

If all three forcecage runes are disabled, the forcecage around all of the exhibits disappears. This leaves

all of the exhibits protected only by mundane glass. Each 10 foot section of glass has AC 15 and 10 hit points. When reduced to 0 hit points, that section shatters.

Anadyomene Attacks

If any of the tanks in the Merfolk Sculptures wing are breached, a flood of water gushes onto the surrounding floor, emptying the tank.

The polished floor becomes extremely slippery when wet. For 5 minutes, the 15-foot square of floor in front of a breached tank has the same properties as if grease had been cast on it (spell save DC 10). The Anadyomene sculpture and foo dogs are immune to this effect. Any creature who falls prone in this manner takes 1d4 piercing damage from shattered tank glass.

If Anadyomene's tank is breached, the sculpture falls prone as its supporting water drains. If its diamond is touched, Anadyomene animates. It uses its movement to stand, and then it attacks whatever touched its gem (see Appendix A for stats).

Reinforcements

If Anadyomene animates during business hours, surrounding guests immediately panic and flee. The guards focus first on protecting civilians and ushering them to safety. They then split their focus between Anadyomene and the players. The guards animate the third-floor foo dog once the floor is clear of civilians.

If Anadyomene animates during the night, the third-floor foo dog immediately joins the fight, focusing on the players. The remaining foo dogs stay on their respective floors, attacking the players only if they are encountered on their way out of the building.

In both scenarios, additional guards from other floors arrive every 1d4 round(s). Guards fight to incapacitate the players rather than kill them. In 5 minutes, the city guard arrives on the scene and starts making arrests.

Allies and Turncoats

If the players disabled the magic circle, Glory Strikes the Storm will likely be present for the battle. If the players have earned her goodwill during the course of the adventure, she does her best to protect the players during the fight. If the players have been disrespectful, she focuses only on Anadyomene. As soon as she has the gem, she uses her action to remove the enchantment or crush it.

If the players have allied with Florence the Cat, she pursues her own goals as soon as all of the

forcecage wards are disabled. She waits until the party has drawn the guards' attention, then slips down to the second floor and the Mithril exhibit. She does not hesitate to betray or attack the party if she thinks it will benefit her.

The Getaway

Escape

If the players attempt to flee during the night, they must evade the foo dogs on each level to reach the door, as well as any guards that have not reached the melee with Anadyomene. During the day, they may be able to blend with the fleeing crowd if the fight has lasted three rounds or less (DC 15 Charisma (Performance) check). The private sanctum enchantment prevents anyone from escaping with teleportation.

If Glory Strikes the Storm is present, she casts wind walk on herself and all living characters as soon as she has the gem in her hands.

Wish

If Glory Strikes the Storm receives her gem, she fulfills her end of the bargain as soon as the characters are in a safe place. She offers to cast wish on the behalf of one member of the party. She will wait a few minutes for the party to deliberate, but if they dither for too long she tells them to make up their minds or come find her on the Plane of Air.

As the GM, you may determine the scope of her powers and what she can reasonably bring to pass with her wish. If the party has not treated her well, Glory Strikes the Storm may pervert the intention of the spell.

Once the spell is cast, Glory Strikes the Storm bids the party farewell, fills the room with swirling storm clouds, and casts plane shift to return to the Plane of Air.

Aftermath

In the aftermath of a robbery, the museum closes for at least a week. During this time, all of the security measures are repaired and redoubled.

Depending on how carefully the party covered their tracks, they may be pursued by the law. The thieves' guild may take notice of such a high-profile robbery. Or the party may get away scot-free, perpetrators of an ingenious heist.

They get their wish, and Glory Strikes the Storm is very happy to be home.

Appendix A: NPCs

Glory Strikes the Storm

Overview

Imperious quest-giver, CG female djinni

Glory Strikes the Storm is a noble djinni trapped on the material plane. She is proud and hotheaded but honorable. She does not have a subtle bone in her body, and when she gets excited her voice rises into booming thunderclaps.

History

Glory Strikes the Storm married an adventurer many years ago and came to the material plane to be with her. To insure that she and her lover were never separated across the planes, Glory Strikes the Storm anchored herself to a diamond. After many years, her mortal lover died. The heartsick djinni buried her wife and went to the secret place where they kept the gemstone. It was gone.

Glory Strikes the Storm has tracked the diamond across the continent and finally located it inside the Modern Artworks Museum. Since she cannot enter the museum herself, she seeks a proxy to do it for her.

Glory's Gemstone

Glory Strikes the Storm enchanted a gemstone to anchor herself to the material plane. She cannot leave the plane the gemstone is on. The gem has no other power over her, though she is afraid that a powerful magic user could use it to enslave her. If she is holding the diamond, Glory Strikes the Storm can use an action to break the enchantment. Destroying the gem also breaks the enchantment.

In Battle

Glory Strikes the Storm uses the stats of a djinni, with the following additions. She only deals half damage to Anadyomene, and she will not kill guards or civilians. She can cast wish on behalf of a mortal once per year.

Dr. Carda Halftusk

Overview

Senior curator, LN female half-orc noble

Dr. Carda Halftusk is a brilliant and idealistic noblewoman scholar. She assumes that everyone around

her is as fascinated by art and history as she is and rambles on pet subjects. The museum's art collection is her life's work.

Keys

Dr. Halftusk keeps her staff keys on her person and the key to the archives locked in her office. She knows the password to disable the darkness spell on the archives: lux et veritas.

Location

Seminar, her office (area 14), Gala.

Rinaldo Bardi

Overview

Embittered ex-employee, NE male human noble

Almost completely lacking in redeeming qualities, Rinaldo Bardi is arrogant, entitled, and foolish. He speaks mostly in sarcastic rhetorical questions.

Rinaldo is the museum director's nephew, and he was recently a museum docent for less than two weeks. He is outraged at his dismissal and regularly comes to the museum to harass his former coworkers.

Key

He still has his staff key, and he will sell it for 300gp. The key opens the staff doors in areas 3, 4 and 9.

Location

Tapestry exhibit (area 8), the Gala

Florence the Cat

Overview

Ambitious thief, CE female halfling assassin

Florence is a thief with her eyes on the upper ranks of the thieves' guild. She has a reputation for flashy thefts and wants into the museum's mithril exhibit. If she allies with the party, she can use her thief skills and chime of opening to great effect. She will not hesitate to betray the party once their shared goal is accomplished.

Chime of Opening

Florence possesses a chime of opening with four charges remaining.

Location

Sketch and Sip (area 16)

Luca Lomeo

Overview

Overworked underling, NG male elf acolyte

Luca Lomeo is a graduate student starting the long climb of a career in the humanities. He is the museum's scribe, transcribing copies of any documents the curators need and keeping notes for the museum's meetings, transactions and events. He is very intelligent but needs to get more sleep.

Location

The Scriptorium (area 12), Library (area 6)

Anadyomene

A sculpture made with the enchanted diamond of Glory Strikes the Storm. The magic in the diamond has animated the statue.

Anadyomene has the stats of a clay golem with the following additional resistances and abilities.

The description for Anadyomene is in area 18.

Stats

Anadyomene

Clay Golem

Damage Resistances. Any attack or spell from Glory Strikes the Storm

Diamond Heart. A critical hit scored on Anadyomene shatters its gemstone and kills the creature instantly.

Foo Dog

The enchanted foo dog statues use the stats of an earth elemental, with the following additional ability. The description for foo dogs is in area 3.

Stats

Foo Dog

Earth Elemental

Dispel Invisibility. Any invisible creature that comes within 60 feet of the foo dog becomes visible. If the invisibility is caused by a spell, the spell ends. If the invisibility is caused by an item or other effect, the creature remains visible as long as it is within 60 feet of the foo dog.

Wizard Guard

Wizards hired to protect the museum. They have the stats of a transmuter (VGtM, p. 218) with the following additional skills and abilities.

Stats

Wizard Guard

Transmuter

- Skills: Insight +4, Perception +4
- Senses: Passive Perception 14

Alarm Level. The wizard gains a bonus to all Perception and Insight checks equal to the alarm level of the museum.

Museum Guard

Warriors hired to protect the museum.

Stats

Museum Guard

Medium humanoid (any race), any non-chaotic alignment

AC, HP, Speed

Armor Class 14 (breastplate)

Hit Points 32 (5d8)

Speed 30 ft.

Ability Scores

Strength	Dexterity	Constitution	Intelligence	Wisdom	Charisma
15 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)

Skills, Senses, CR

Skills: Insight +4, Perception +4

Senses: Passive Perception 14

Languages: any one language (usually Common)

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Features

Alarm Level. The museum guard gains a bonus to all Perception and Insight checks equal to the alarm level of the museum.

Pack Tactics. The museum guard has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the museum guard's allies is within 5 ft. of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Actions

Multiattack. The museum guard makes two melee attacks.

Short Spear. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Heavy Crossbow. Ranged Weapon Attack: +2 to hit, range 100/400 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d10) piercing damage.

Appendix B: Spells

An abbreviated version of museum's major enchantments is reproduced here. Many features of these spells are not relevant to the museum's defenses (such as casting time or placement options) and are not included. The affected area of the spells has also been modified. The museum forcecages cover all of the exhibits, and the magic circle covers the entire museum.

Forcecage

7th-level evocation

Duration: Until runes are disabled

An immobile, invisible, cube-shaped prison composed of magical force springs into existence around an area you choose within range. The prison can be a cage or a solid box, as you choose.

A prison in the shape of a box can be up to 10 feet on a side, creating a solid barrier that prevents any matter from passing through it and blocking any spells cast into or out from the area.

The cage also extends into the Ethereal Plane, blocking ethereal travel.

This spell can't be dispelled by dispel magic.

For the purposes of this module, while a the full text of the spell explains how a trapped creature might teleport out of a forcecage, teleporting into one is impossible.

Magic Circle

3th-level abjuration

Duration: Until rune is disabled

You create a cylinder of magical energy centered on a point on the ground that you can see within range. Glowing runes appear wherever the cylinder intersects with the floor or other surface.

Choose one or more of the following types of creatures: celestials, elementals, fey, fiends, or undead. The circle affects a creature of the chosen type in the following ways:

- The creature can't willingly enter the cylinder by nonmagical means. If the creature tries to use teleportation or interplanar travel to do so, it must first succeed on a Charisma saving throw.
- The creature has disadvantage on attack rolls against targets within the cylinder.

- Targets within the cylinder can't be charmed, frightened, or possessed by the creature.

When you cast this spell, you can elect to cause its magic to operate in the reverse direction, preventing a creature of the specified type from leaving the cylinder and protecting targets outside it.

Private Sanctum

3th-level abjuration

Duration: Permanent

You make an area within range magically secure. The area is a cube that can be as small as 5 feet to as large as 100 feet on each side. The spell lasts for the duration or until you use an action to dismiss it.

When you cast the spell, you decide what sort of security the spell provides, choosing any or all of the following properties:

- Sensors created by divination spells can't appear inside the protected area or pass through the barrier at its perimeter.
- Creatures in the area can't be targeted by divination spells.
- Nothing can teleport into or out of the warded area.
- Planar travel is blocked within the warded area.

Casting this spell on the same spot every day for a year makes this effect permanent.

The private sanctum spell prevents Glory Strikes the Storm from using teleportation travel to bypass the magic circle.

Credits

To my dad, my first DM

Layout: GM Binder

Stat Blocks: D&D 5e Statblock Generator

Editor: Cindy Butor

Cover Art: Ellie Lynn

This module was created in 30 days, a feat that would not have been possible without Ashley Warren and the instructors and participants at the RPG Writer Workshop. Thank you so much!

And to my inimitable players, thanks for surprising me in so many ways.

Legal

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS, D&D, Wizards of the Coast, Forgotten Realms, Ravenloft, Eberron, the dragon ampersand, Ravnica and all other Wizards of the Coast product names, and their respective logos are trademarks of Wizards of the Coast in the USA and other countries.

This work contains material that is copyright Wizards of the Coast and/or other authors. Such material is used with permission under the Community Content Agreement for Dungeon Masters Guild.

All other original material in this work is copyright 2019 by Ellie Lynn and published under the Community Content Agreement for Dungeon Masters Guild.

Brochure

A. Foyer

Enjoy all of the museum's exhibits for 4gp a day

B. Frescoes

Cutting-edge painting techniques give breathtaking life to these dyed plaster canvases

C. Arms of Saint Sergia

See the weapons and armor wielded in the days of Saint Sergia

D. Arcane Calligraphy

Artists imbue both beauty and power in these magical inscriptions

E. Restrooms

F. Divine Triptychs

A pantheon of beauty, the gods traced by the mortal paintbrush

G. Tapestry Art

Stone walls transformed into living landscapes

H. Statuary

See marble brought to life by the hands of innovative master sculptors

I. Mithril of Ornhelm

The mundane becomes extraordinary – toys, weapons and jewelry made from the rarest of metals

J. Cafe and Shop

Enjoy a refreshing beverage under a stunning fresco ceiling

K. Dominic Halftusk Memorial Gallery

The Soul of a Butterfly: teaware and luthiery

L. Merfolk Sculpture

Stone floats and sculptures breathe in the hands of aquatic sculptors

Events

The History of Jewelry

Learn about the evolution of jewelry from the museum's senior curator, Dr. Carda Halftusk

Sketch and Sip

Foster your artistic talent in the inspiring atmosphere of the Modern Artworks Museum

Gala

Enjoy a night of splendor at the museum's yearly fundraising event